



Debra Nelson <[REDACTED]>

FW: Debra Nelson

1 message

Barnes, Kenneth <Kenny.Barnes@mail.house.gov>
To: Debra Nelson <[REDACTED]>

Thu, Apr 2, 2026 at 4:03 PM

Ms. Nelson,

You stated that the Department of War contacted you regarding an inquiry from Congressman Clyburn's office. I am not sure when you received the information from the Department of War as it is called now but an inquiry was sent to the Department of Defense as it was called at the time of your issue and a response was sent to you May 1, 2025 regarding your issue from the Department of Defense. Please see below.

Unfortunately, legal matters are not in the jurisdiction of the Congressman's office. The Origin of the document referenced in the email came from Congressman Clyburn's office. To find out if your information was accessed you would need to request a FOIA from the agency involved.

V/r

Kenneth Barnes
Pee Dee Area Director
Office of Congressman James E. Clyburn
130 West Main Street
Kingstree, SC 29556
843-355-1211
843-355-1232fax
kenny.barnes@mail.house.gov

-----Original Message-----

From: Barnes, Kenneth
Sent: Thursday, May 1, 2025 1:17 PM
To: Debra Nelson <[REDACTED]>
Subject: FW: Debra Nelson

Ms. Nelson,

Please see below the final response that was received by Congressman Clyburn regarding your inquiry to the Department of Defense. Thank you for contacting Congressman Clyburn's office.

V/r

Kenneth Barnes
Pee Dee Area Director
Office of Congressman James E. Clyburn
130 West Main Street
Kingstree, SC 29556
843-355-1211
843-355-1232fax
kenny.barnes@mail.house.gov

Congressman Clyburn,

This is in response to your March 1, 2024, email regarding the status of a reprisal complaint filed with the Department of Defense Office of the Inspector General by Ms. Debra Nelson, a former Curtiss-Wright employee. On June 20, October 7, and December 11, 2024, we informed you that Ms.

Nelson filed complaints with the U.S. Equal Employment Opportunity Commission (EEOC) and the National Labor

Relations Board (NLRB). We also informed you that Ms. Nelson's EEOC complaint was closed and that her NLRB complaint was still open, and that our Whistleblower Reprisal Investigations (WRI) Directorate placed the reprisal case in abeyance awaiting the NLRB's inquiry determination.

On March 13, the NLRB informed WRI that it investigated and closed Ms. Nelson's allegation of unfair labor practice based on protected activity. The NLRB dismissed Ms. Nelson's allegation based on insufficient evidence to establish a violation of the act. On March 13, 2024, WRI reviewed and closed its case because under section 4701, title 10, United States Code (10 U.S.C. § 4701), "Contractor Employees: Protection from Reprisal for Disclosure of Certain Information," Paragraph (b)(2)(A), no Inspector General investigation is required if the complaint was previously addressed in another Federal or state judicial or administrative proceeding initiated by the complainant. Accordingly, as Ms. Nelson's substantially similar retaliation complaint was previously addressed in a Federal administrative proceeding initiated by her, WRI closed its case and notified Ms. Nelson.

If you have any questions, please let me know. Thank you.

V/r,
Congressional Liaison
Dept. of Defense Office of Inspector General